Client and Topic

I intend to create a design portfolio website as my final project. I know that I will eventually need to have a portfolio of my work that I can submit in job applications after graduation. I think that this is the perfect opportunity to begin working on it.

Development Process and Engagement

In order to ensure that I create a portfolio that is both professional and engaging, I will research examples of successful portfolios as well as portfolio design advice from professionals in the UX/UI design industry. While I already have a basic understanding of what my portfolio will look like, I believe that there is always room to improve. I will also need to create case studies of my previous projects that highlight what hiring managers are looking for in a UX/UI designer.

Description

My goal is to be hired as a UX/UI designer post-graduation. My portfolio-site will display my understanding of user experience and user interface design. The target audience for this website includes hiring managers, recruiters, and senior UX/UI professionals involved in evaluating candidates for design positions. These individuals vary in age, education level, location, and professional responsibilities, but they all share the goal of quickly assessing whether a candidate has the knowledge, skills, and experience necessary for a role. Because these users often review portfolios on desktop computers, laptops, and mobile devices, the website must be responsive, easy to navigate, and focused on presenting information efficiently. The following personas represent the primary audiences that the website is intended to serve.

Persona 1: Hiring Manager

Name: Sarah Martinez
Age: 42
Location: Chicago, Illinois
Education: Bachelor's Degree in Business Administration
Occupation: Hiring Manager at a mid-sized technology company
Income Level: Upper-middle income

Sarah reviews dozens of applications for open UX/UI positions. She does not spend much time on each portfolio, often making an initial judgment within a few minutes. She primarily accesses candidate portfolios on a desktop computer during work hours. Her goal is to quickly determine whether a candidate has relevant skills, strong communication abilities, and professional-quality work.

Design Considerations:

- Clear navigation
- Fast loading pages

- Easy access to resume and contact information
- Concise project summaries
- Professional visual design

Persona 2: Senior UX Designer

Name: David Chen
Age: 35
Location: Seattle, Washington
Education: Master's Degree in Human-Computer Interaction
Occupation: Senior UX Designer and Technical Interviewer
Income Level: High income

David participates in the interview process by evaluating portfolios for design quality and problem-solving ability. He carefully reviews case studies and wants to understand the research, design decisions, and outcomes behind each project. He accesses portfolios primarily on a desktop computer and may revisit them multiple times throughout the hiring process.

Design Considerations:

- Detailed case studies
- Clearly explained design process
- User research findings
- Wireframes and prototypes
- Accessibility and usability evidence
- Visual consistency and design rationale

Persona 3: Recruiter

Name: Amanda Johnson
Age: 29
Location: Austin, Texas
Education: Bachelor's Degree in Human Resources
Occupation: Technical Recruiter
Income Level: Middle income

Amanda searches for candidates and conducts initial screenings. She frequently reviews portfolios from a laptop or mobile phone while managing multiple open positions. She needs to quickly understand a candidate's background, specialties, and experience level. She often shares portfolio links with hiring managers and design teams.

Design Considerations:

- Mobile-responsive design
- Strong personal branding
- Clear summary of skills and experience
- Easy-to-find portfolio projects
- Obvious contact methods
- LinkedIn and resume access

The website's content will be reviewed at least once every semester and updated whenever new projects, certifications, skills, or professional achievements are completed.

Growth and Maintenance

I think that the website will continue to grow and evolve as I do in my design work. I will need to purchase a domain name before actually submitting my portfolio in a job application. As I complete more projects during my degree program and throughout my career, I will continue adding new case studies and examples of my work. To make the website easier to maintain, I will use a consistent page structure for all case studies and organize files logically. Regular maintenance tasks will include updating project content, checking for broken links, reviewing accessibility, and ensuring that contact information remains current. Most of these tasks will only need to be completed a few times per year, while link and functionality checks should be performed monthly.

Testing

Before launching the website, I will conduct several rounds of testing to ensure that everything functions as intended. I will review every page to confirm that all navigation links, buttons, images, and downloadable files work correctly. I will also ask classmates, friends, or family members to use the website and provide feedback regarding usability, readability, and ease of navigation. Their feedback will help identify issues that I may overlook as the designer. Because my target audience consists of hiring managers and design professionals, I will pay close attention to first impressions and overall usability. I will test the website in Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox, and Safari to ensure a consistent experience across major browsers and devices.

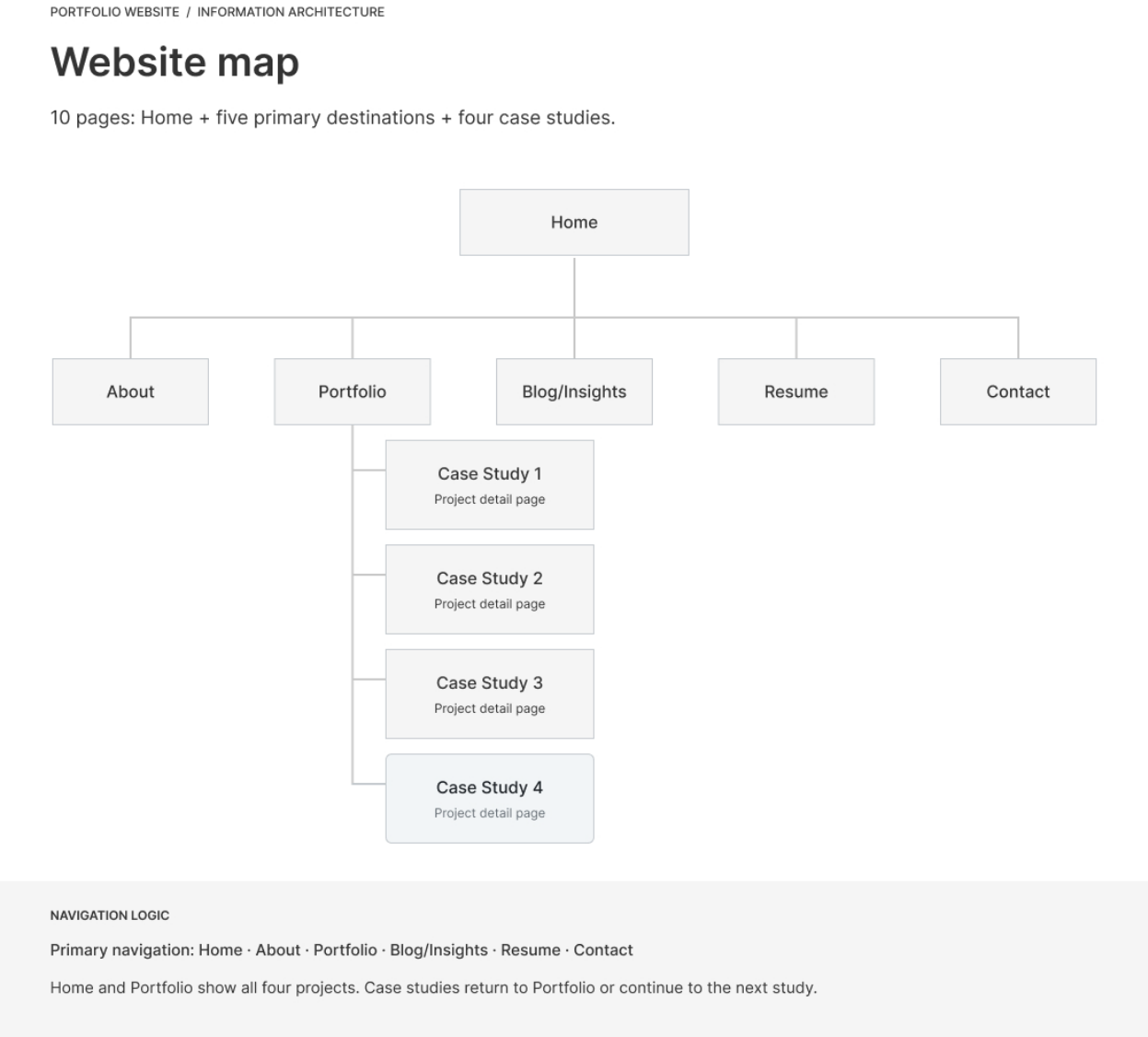
Organization

The website content will be organized around presenting my design skills, professional background, and portfolio projects. The home page will introduce who I am, my career goals, and provide quick access to important sections of the site. Additional pages will include an About

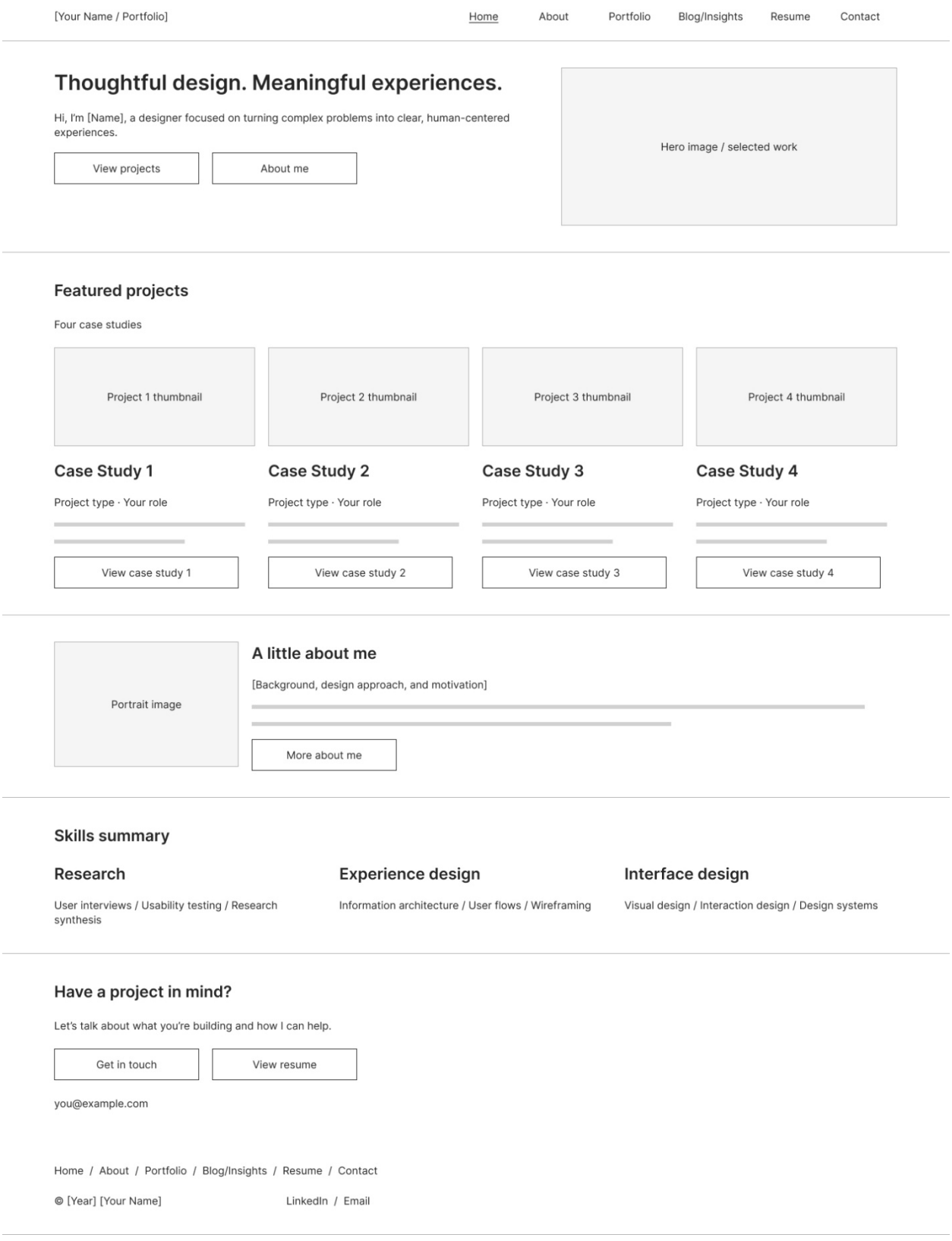
page, a Portfolio page, individual Case Study pages, a Blog or Insights page, a Resume page, and a Contact page. The portfolio section will contain detailed case studies that explain my design process, research, wireframes, prototypes, and final outcomes.

The website navigation will be simple and consistent across all pages. A horizontal navigation menu will appear at the top of each page and include links to the major sections of the site. The home page layout will contain a hero section, featured projects, a short biography, and a call-to-action directing visitors to view my work. Interior pages will follow a structured layout with headings, supporting images, and written content.

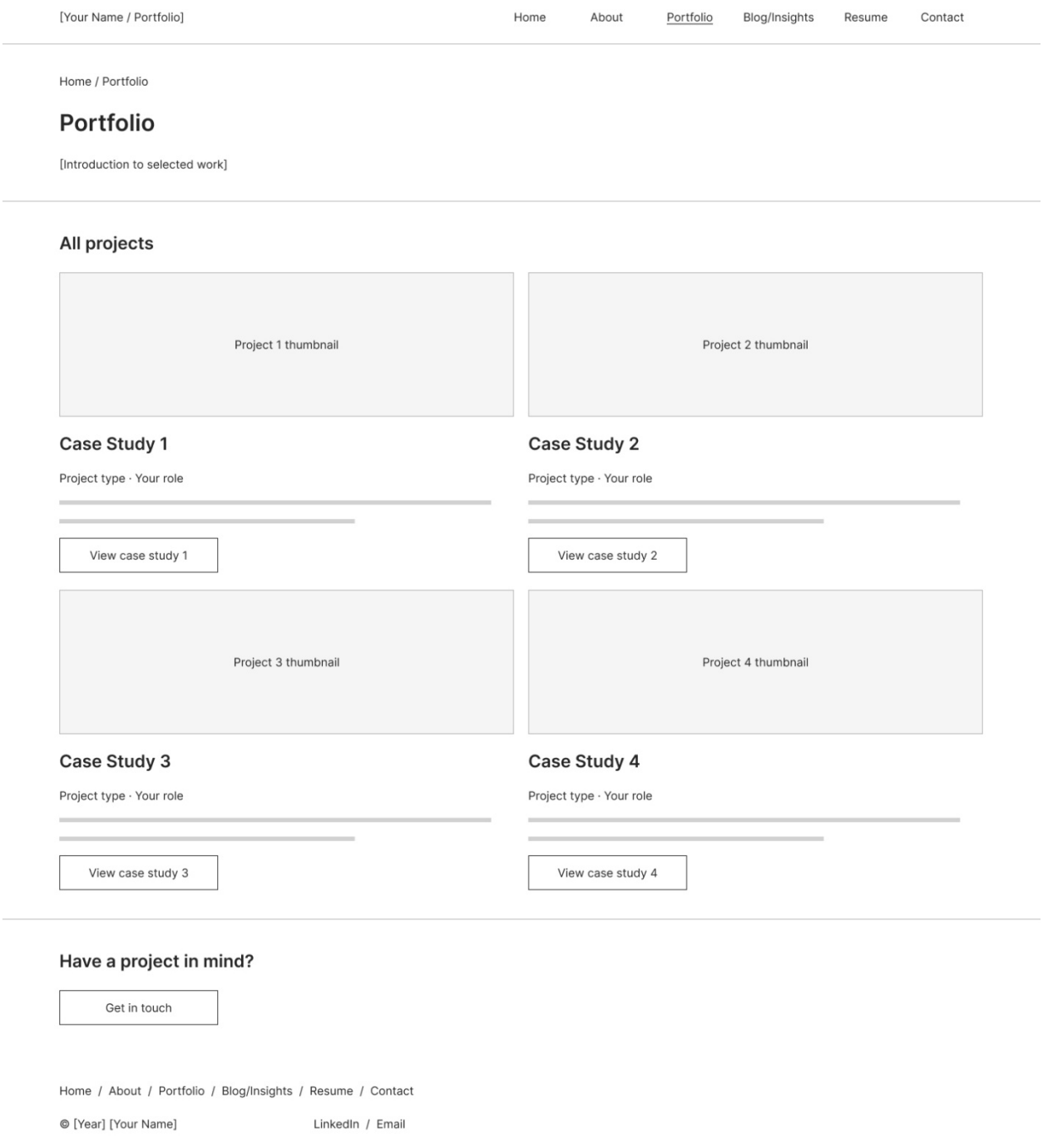
Sitemap



Home page wireframe



Portfolio page wireframe



This organization provides a logical flow from introduction to portfolio review and finally to contacting me for employment opportunities.

Security

The website will not include an e-commerce component because there will be no products or services available for purchase. The majority of the website content will remain publicly accessible because the purpose of the site is to showcase my work to potential employers and professional connections. For that reason, there will not be a need for password-protected content or user accounts. From a security perspective, I can still take several steps as the website designer and developer to help protect the website. These steps include using HTTPS encryption through an SSL certificate, keeping all software and plug-ins updated, using strong passwords for administrative access, limiting unnecessary third-party integrations, validating user input on contact forms, and regularly backing up website files to prevent data loss.

Web Hosting

When selecting a web host, I will evaluate several criteria rather than choosing the first available option. Reliability and uptime will be important because I need employers to be able to access my portfolio at any time. Performance and loading speed will also be significant factors because slow websites create a poor user experience. I will compare hosting providers based on security features, storage capacity, scalability, technical support, and pricing. As my portfolio grows, I want a hosting solution that can accommodate additional content without requiring a complete migration.

The website will require SSL support to provide secure connections and improve credibility. A contact form may also require email functionality through server-side technologies. The website primarily will rely on HTML, CSS, and JavaScript because these technologies are well-suited for creating a modern portfolio website. If additional functionality becomes necessary, support for PHP or another server-side language may also be beneficial.

One available domain name that would work well for the website is ezrabrewerdesign.com. This domain is professional, easy to remember, and directly associates the website with my personal brand. Using my name in the domain also makes it easier for hiring managers and recruiters to locate my portfolio after reviewing my resume or application materials.

Marketing

The primary purpose of the website is to support my professional job search, so many marketing efforts will be connected to career development activities. I will include the portfolio link on my resume, LinkedIn profile, email signature, and other professional networking platforms. Sharing portfolio projects on social media may also help increase visibility and attract opportunities from recruiters and design professionals.

Several SEO practices can be implemented during development. These include using descriptive page titles, meaningful heading structures, optimized images, clear navigation, mobile-responsive design, fast-loading pages, and relevant keywords related to UX design, UI design,

user research, and portfolio work. These practices can improve search engine visibility while also creating a better experience for users visiting the website.